SMS RESEARCH FORUM 2026–27

Committee Responsibilities, Duties & Instructions

This document outlines the responsibilities of the SMS Research Forum committees and the general expectations for committee heads and members.

1. Committee Responsibilities at a Glance

Committee	Key Responsibilities
Programme Committee	Plan and coordinate research programmes, workshops, seminars, expert talks, paper discussions and colloquia. Prepare annual/monthly programme plans and coordinate speakers and participants.
Editorial Committee	Prepare content for publicity and communications; draft reports and newsletter material; maintain written publication records; coordinate alumni relations, placement information and career-related activities.
Social & Welfare Committee	Promote scholar interaction, welfare and peer support; organise social and interactive activities; communicate common concerns of research scholars to the appropriate authority.
Technical Committee	Handle design and digital production, digital publicity and platform management, photography/video, digital archiving, and technical support for in-person, online and hybrid programmes. TA/ Invigilation Duty Allotment
Finance Committee	Prepare programme budgets, coordinate approved financial requirements, maintain bills and records, and ensure compliance with institutional financial procedures.

Instructions to Committee Heads

- Prepare an annual activity plan for the committee.
- Clearly delegate duties among committee members.
- Coordinate with other committees whenever joint support is required.
- Obtain necessary approval before finalising programmes, expenditure or official communications.
- Maintain proper records and documentation of activities.
- Submit a brief report after each major activity.
- Review the committee's progress periodically.
- Ensure professional, timely and effective coordination among members.
- Maintain continuity by properly handing over records and responsibilities when required.

2. Programme Committee

Main role: Planning and conducting research-oriented programmes and academic activities.

Duties

- Prepare the annual/monthly Research Forum programme calendar.
- Identify suitable programmes, including research methodology workshops; research talks and expert sessions; research paper discussions; proposal/model development sessions; publishing and journal selection sessions; research skill-development programmes; and doctoral colloquia.
- Coordinate with resource persons, speakers and faculty members.
- Prepare programme schedules and session plans.
- Coordinate registration and participant management, working with the Technical Committee where digital forms or platforms are needed.
- Ensure the smooth conduct of programmes.

- Collect feedback after programmes and share relevant summaries with the Editorial Committee.
- Maintain a record of programmes conducted and participation.
- Coordinate with other committees whenever their support is required.

Committee Head – Instructions

- Prepare the programme plan well in advance.
- Assign specific responsibilities to committee members.
- Maintain a programme-wise checklist.
- Coordinate with the Research Forum Coordinator and obtain necessary approval before finalising programmes.
- Provide accurate programme details, speaker information and schedules to the Editorial Committee in time for content preparation.
- Inform the Technical Committee early about equipment, platform, design and digital support requirements.
- Submit a brief report after every programme, providing the relevant information to the Editorial Committee for publication and record-keeping.

3. Editorial Committee

Main role: Preparation and coordination of content, communication materials, documentation, Research Forum publications, and alumni- and placement-related activities.

A. Content Creation and Communication

- Prepare the written content for publicity materials, posters, invitations, announcements and social media posts.
- Draft programme descriptions, event announcements, speaker profiles, captions and other communication materials.
- Prepare the content for Google Forms, including registration forms, feedback forms, certificates and other programme-related forms.
- Prepare programme reports, news updates, summaries and other written documentation.
- Coordinate with the Programme Committee to obtain accurate programme details, speaker information, schedules and other relevant content.
- Prepare content for the quarterly Research Forum newsletter, including research activities, scholar achievements, publications, awards and other academic developments.
- Collect and verify information about research scholars' achievements, subject to the required approval.
- Coordinate with the Technical Committee to ensure that prepared content is incorporated into posters, digital publications, social media materials and other outputs in a timely manner.

B. Documentation and Publications

- Prepare written reports after major Research Forum activities.
- Compile information for the quarterly newsletter and annual Research Forum report.
- Collect programme details, attendance information, feedback summaries and other relevant inputs from the concerned committees.
- Maintain the written content and publication records required for Research Forum activities.
- Ensure the accuracy, clarity and consistency of all prepared content.
- Coordinate with the Technical Committee for the design, formatting, digital production and archiving of documents and publications.

C. Placement and Alumni Coordination

- Maintain an updated and verified database of SMS alumni who may support placement and career-related activities.
- Establish and maintain communication with the Alumni Group.
- Identify alumni working in universities and colleges, corporates, research organisations, government institutions, consultancy and other relevant sectors.
- Collect and circulate verified information about job openings, internships, research opportunities and academic positions.

- Coordinate alumni interaction sessions, career talks and networking opportunities.
- Invite alumni and recruiters for career-oriented sessions, where appropriate and with the necessary approval.
- Coordinate with the institutional Placement Committee whenever required.
- Maintain records of opportunities circulated, alumni interactions and career-related activities.
- Submit periodic updates on placement and alumni activities.

Committee Head – Instructions

- Assign members specific roles for content writing, newsletter preparation, documentation, and alumni/placement coordination.
- Establish a timely content-submission workflow with the Programme and Technical Committees.
- Verify the accuracy of content before submitting it for design or publication.
- Ensure that official content and communications are released only after the required approval.
- Coordinate the preparation and publication of the quarterly newsletter.
- Ensure that alumni and placement information is authentic and that no commitments are made on behalf of SMS/CUSAT without approval.
- Ensure that relevant written content and records are handed over properly at the end of the committee's term.

4. Social & Welfare Committee

Main role: Scholar welfare, interaction, inclusiveness and social activities.

Duties

- Organise activities that promote interaction and bonding among research scholars.
- Identify and communicate common welfare concerns of scholars.
- Support new research scholars in becoming familiar with the department and Research Forum.
- Organise informal academic/social gatherings when appropriate.
- Coordinate celebrations and special observances related to the Research Forum.
- Encourage peer support among scholars.
- Promote a positive and inclusive research environment.
- Support scholars during major Research Forum programmes.
- Collect suggestions and concerns from scholars and communicate them to the appropriate authority.
- Organise social responsibility/community-oriented activities where feasible.

Committee Head – Instructions

- Ensure participation is inclusive and voluntary.
- Maintain a positive and respectful environment.
- Give equal opportunity to committee members to contribute.
- Bring genuine welfare concerns to the Research Forum Coordinator or appropriate authority.
- Avoid taking administrative decisions without approval.

5. Technical Committee

Main role: Digital design and production, publicity execution, digital record management, and technical assistance for Research Forum programmes and activities.

A. Design and Digital Production

- Design and produce posters, invitations, announcements and other publicity materials using content supplied by the Editorial Committee.
- Format and prepare social media materials, digital publications and newsletter layouts.
- Design templates for posters, reports, presentations, certificates and other Research Forum materials.

- Create and maintain standard visual formats for the Research Forum's digital communications.
- Coordinate with the Editorial Committee to ensure approved content is presented accurately and professionally.
- Support the digital presentation and publication of research achievements, scholar publications, awards and other academic accomplishments, subject to approval.

B. Digital Platforms and Publicity Execution

- Manage authorised Research Forum WhatsApp groups, social media accounts and other digital communication platforms.
- Publish or circulate approved posters, announcements, newsletters and other digital materials.
- Coordinate with the Editorial Committee to ensure timely publication of programme-related information.
- Assist in creating and managing online registration and feedback forms, based on the content prepared by the Editorial Committee.
- Ensure that digital communications follow the required approval procedures.

C. Photography, Digital Records and Archives

- Take photographs and videos during Research Forum programmes.
- Maintain a systematic digital archive of posters and invitations; attendance records; photographs and videos; programme reports; feedback records; certificates; important communications; newsletters; and other digital publications.
- Ensure that digital files are properly labelled, organised and stored.
- Coordinate with the Editorial Committee to collect the final content and documentation required for archiving.
- Assist in maintaining the annual digital record of Research Forum activities.

D. Technical Assistance

- Arrange technical requirements for seminars, workshops and presentations, including projectors/displays, laptops/computers, microphones, speakers/audio, internet/connectivity and online meeting platforms.
- Provide technical support for hybrid and online programmes.
- Assist resource persons and participants with presentation requirements and digital tools.
- Conduct technical checks before every programme.
- Support online meeting platforms and digital resources of the Research Forum.
- Maintain a checklist of technical equipment and requirements.
- Identify possible technical problems in advance and keep alternatives ready.
- Coordinate early with the Programme Committee regarding technical requirements.
- Ensure that institutional equipment is handled responsibly.

Committee Head – Instructions

- Conduct a technical check before every programme.
- Identify possible technical problems in advance and keep alternatives ready.
- Assign specific design, digital-platform, archive and technical responsibilities to committee members.
- Establish a workflow for receiving content from the Editorial Committee and converting it into finished digital materials.
- Ensure that designs and digital publications use approved content.
- Coordinate publication schedules with the Editorial Committee.
- Maintain consistent design templates and digital archive standards.
- Ensure that official materials are published only after the required approval.
- Coordinate early with the Programme Committee regarding technical requirements and handle institutional equipment responsibly.

6. Finance Committee

Main role: Financial planning, budgeting and maintaining transparent financial records.

Duties

- Prepare estimated budgets for Research Forum activities.
- Maintain records of approved expenditure.
- Coordinate financial requirements with the concerned authority.
- Maintain bills, receipts and supporting documents.
- Track programme-wise expenditure.
- Prepare expenditure statements wherever required.
- Assist in planning financially feasible programmes.
- Coordinate with other committees regarding their budget requirements.
- Ensure that the financial procedures of the University/Department are followed.

Committee Head – Instructions

- No expenditure should be committed without prior approval.
- Obtain estimates/quotations where required by institutional procedures.
- Maintain proper bills and supporting documents.
- Keep financial records updated after every programme.
- Coordinate with the Research Forum Coordinator before finalising financial commitments.
- Submit expenditure details promptly after an activity.

General Instructions for All Committee Heads

1. **Plan in advance**: Every committee should prepare an activity plan for the academic year.
2. **Delegate responsibilities**: The Committee Head should not handle every task personally.
3. **Maintain coordination**: Committees should work together rather than function independently.
4. **Seek approval**: Activities, external invitations, expenditure and official communications should follow the required approval process.
5. **Maintain records**: Every activity should have proper documentation.
6. **Meet periodically**: Committee Heads should review progress with their members.
7. **Submit reports**: A brief report should be submitted after every major activity.
8. **Avoid duplication**: Before planning an activity, check whether another committee is already undertaking a similar initiative.
9. **Communicate through the Research Forum Coordinator** where decisions require departmental or institutional approval.
10. **Ensure continuity**: Important files, contacts, templates and records should be properly handed over to the next committee.
11. **Maintain professional conduct**: All communications with faculty, alumni, resource persons and external organisations should be professional.
12. **Share team responsibility**: The Committee Head is responsible for ensuring that assigned work is completed, but responsibilities should be shared among members.